Resume

Contact: David Coleman

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Visiting student application at the Faculty of Environment and Resource Management, Mahidol University

Seeking to undertake courses from the Masters of Environmental and Resource Management (International Program) as part of the Australian government's New Colombo Plan Scholarship Scheme.

Personable individual with an excellent academic record including fieldwork and practical skills developed from employment at the University of Sydney, Australia and from undertaking voluntary overseas learning programs. Highly articulate individual with the ability to achieve solid results in a range of fields including soil science, hydrology, biological concepts and chemistry. Possesses a knowledge of and keen interest in the field of food security, with a solid theoretical understanding of scientific concepts of environmental systems and practical experience in crop research design and implementation. Acquires skills quickly and is able to operate easily in diverse workplace cultures and situations. Is a 2014 Crawford Fund Scholar and received a New Colombo Plan Scholarship for 2015. Winner of the Individual Award at the Australian Soil Judging Championships. Seeking an opportunity to gain valuable experience and a new perspective on environmental and agricultural science at the prestigious Mahidol University over the year from August 2015 to June 2016.

Key Skills:

- Passion and initiative in gaining experience in food security related projects
- Ability for high quality independent work
- Experimental and project design
- Proven Reliability and trust in fieldwork
- Highly articulate writing styles.
- Team work
- Public speaking experience
- Statistical analysis
- Software skills: Microsoft Excel, JMP, R computer coding, Genstat Analysis

Education:

Bachelor of Environmental Systems, University of Sydney, 3rd Year. Current GPA: 84

- New Colombo Plan Scholar 2015
- Crawford Fund Scholar 2014
- Sydney University Shortlist for New Colombo Plan Scholarship Scheme
- Winner in the Individual Section of National Soil Judging Championships, Melbourne

Bachelor of Diagnostic Radiography, University of Newcastle, 2007-2009

- Undergraduate High Achievement Scholarship 2007

High School Certificate 2006, UAI: 97.2

- Band 6 in Chemistry, Physics and Extension Mathematics

Employment:

Field Hand,
Department of Agriculture and Environment, University of Sydney, 2012 – present

Teachers Aid,
Special Education Unit, Sydney Secondary College, 2013 - present

Radiographer,
Westmead Children's Hospital, Sydney, 2010-2012

Overseas Experience:

Agro-Ecosystems in Developing Countries – University of Sydney

Personal Qualities and Experience:

I am excited at the prospect of a year in Thailand and will embrace any opportunities that will provide me with unique experiences in the way that issues such as food security and agricultural development are addressed; particularly at the headquarters for Food and Agriculture in the Asia pacific region.

I have developed the skill of report writing throughout my degree to a high level. One of my achievements included receiving the highest mark for my Laos Individual Project on *Nutrient Management in the Savannakhet Province in Lowland Rice Communities.*

High level of reliability. Much of the fieldwork was done in a remote location with little chance to repeat observations. Care, patience and concentration for extended periods of time was essential to most of the tasks. My previous employment as a radiographer required similar levels of meticulous work.

Computing skills including excel, JMP, R programming and ArcGIS have been covered in coursework throughout the degree. This experience has also emphasised the importance of attention to detail when dealing with scientific data.

I will bring enthusiasm to the work. As a mature age undergraduate student, I chose to follow my interests and am passionate about the issues surrounding food security. I will relish the opportunity to study with such a prestigious organisation as the FAO Asia Pacific Region.

If you require any further information, do not hesitate to contact me and I look forward to hearing from you soon.

Regards

David Coleman

Referees:

Employer and Academic Referee: Dr Tarryn Turnbull, Senior Academic,
Department of Agriculture and Environment,
University of Sydney
Email: tarryn.turnbull@sydney.edu.au
Phone: +61 2 9351 8883
(Includes letter of recommendation)

Current Academic Supervisor: Dr Andrew Merchant
Department of Agriculture and Environment,
University of Sydney
Email: stephen.cattle@sydney.edu.au
Phone: +61 2 86271142

Dr Tarryn Turnbull, Senior Academic,

Department of Agriculture and Environment,

University of Sydney

Email: tarryn.turnbull@sydney.edu.au

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To whom it may concern

David was the standout student for the subject I was involved in teaching in 2012 ENSY1002. His excellent ability to comprehend what is being taught combined with a curiosity to learn above and beyond the curriculum made him quite a unique and memorable student. We approached David for his casual employment based upon his clear academic merit, generous tendencies and his clear ability to work well with others.

David has demonstrated a clear desire to give back to the communities to which he belongs. He has joined and participated in the activities of the Sydney Landcare Group, he is a member of the Agriculture Society at the University of Sydney and he has embraced every opportunity the University of Sydney has offered him to become involved in. These include the non-compulsory field trip to rural Australia (The Pilbara, WA) and Laos.

David has worked in a casual capacity for me for two years, our workplace is filled with staff and students from an exhaustive range of cultures/countries of origin and David's natural demeanour has endeared him to all. He is genuinely interested in people and is naturally warm and generous. David's employment potential is extremely high, he is talented with new technology, very self-motivated, able to follow instruction and intuitive, friendly and brilliant academically. I would consider David for any upcoming position to be a clear front-runner.

David is able to manage research projects already. He has proven a very valuable research assistant to students and staff in the field and laboratory and I can honestly say I've never been impressed by an undergraduate student as I have with David. His maturity and personality puts him clearly above his peers and his academic record results from a quick mind and his sheer hard work. I would consider him a fantastic candidate for working in the area of agricultural development.

If you require any further information, do not hesitate to contact me.

Regards

Dr Tarryn Turnbull